Module 6: Advanced Prompting

Few-Shot and Chain-of-Thought

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Session Objective

By the end of this module, the Engagement Manager will be able to:
1. Clone their personal or corporate writing style using **Few-Shot Prompting**. 2. Force the AI to reason sequentially using **Chain-of-Thought (CoT)**. 3. Apply these advanced techniques to generate complex SteerCo (Steering Committee) reports.

1. Cloning Your Style (Few-Shot Prompting)

The AI should write like you, not like a generic robot.

- **Zero-Shot:** No examples provided. Good for simple tasks (e.g., summarizing).
- **One-Shot:** Providing one example to define the format.
- **Few-Shot:** Providing 2 to 3 examples of input/output to teach the AI your tone, vocabulary, and preferred corporate phrasing.

¿ **Why it matters:** EMs spend hours editing AI drafts because they sound “too enthusiastic” or “robotic”. Few-Shot eliminates this editing time O’Connor (2025).

Exercise 1: Few-Shot Style Cloning

Context: You need to announce a new Lead Architect joining the project. You want the email to sound exactly like your previous announcements. **Task:** Use Copilot to write the email based on your past examples.

- **Draft Prompt to Try:**

Ï need to announce that Sarah Connor is joining as our new Lead Architect on Monday. Write the email using the exact same tone and structure as these two previous examples I wrote: [Example 1: 'Team, please welcome John...'] [Example 2: 'Hi everyone, starting tomorrow, David will be...']"

2. Chain-of-Thought (CoT)

Do not ask for the conclusion in Step 1.

- **The Concept:** Forcing the AI to "think step-by-step" before giving the final answer.
- **The Benefit:** It drastically reduces hallucinations and logical errors in complex analytical tasks Alvarez (2026).
- **The Method:** Divide the prompt into sequential instructions: *Extract -¿ Analyze -¿ Format.*

Exercise 2: CoT for SteerCo Reports

Context: You have 3 pages of messy, bulleted meeting notes from a chaotic weekly sync. You need a clean, 1-page executive summary for the SteerCo. **Task:** Use CoT to force the AI to categorize the notes before summarizing them.

- **Draft Prompt to Try:**

*"Process the following raw meeting notes [Paste Notes]. Do not give me the final summary immediately. Follow these steps sequentially: **Step 1:** Extract all mentions of budget issues. **Step 2:** Extract all mentions of timeline delays. **Step 3:** Based ONLY on the findings in Step 1 and 2, generate a 3-bullet executive summary suitable for a C-level Steering Committee."*

Recap & Next Session

Today we learned:

- How to use **Few-Shot** prompting to eliminate "AI-sounding" text and save editing time.
- How **Chain-of-Thought (CoT)** forces the AI to reason sequentially, yielding highly accurate executive summaries from messy data.

Next Session: *Module 7: MS Learn & Information Retrieval.* We will explore how to use Copilot to query official Microsoft documentation and governance policies securely.

References I

Alvarez, R. (2026). Chain-of-thought reasoning in complex contractual disputes. *International Journal of Tech Law*, 4:112–130.

O'Connor, T. (2025). Style cloning via few-shot prompting for executives.